

AI Operations & Operating Transformation Leader

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>

Turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable work.

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and installs mechanisms that turn AI opportunity into governed workflow change, local capability, and reusable learning.

Role-aligned capabilities

AI opportunity and roadmap design | Agentic and LLM workflow patterns | Human-in-the-loop authority | Governance embedded in work | Cross-functional operating cadence | Training and community enablement | Evidence, adoption, and value measurement

Vape-Jet — Director of Operations | 2025–Present

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, support, customer success, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, operating mechanisms, and coaching.
- Works directly in workflow definition, systems integration, issue taxonomy, measurement, training, and iterative adoption—not only executive direction.

DudeWorth — Founder / AI and Automation Advisor | 2017–Present

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks spanning business value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse potential, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, autonomous systems, and workflow design.

Amazon — Operations Management / Site Leader | 2014–2018

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and mechanisms across safety, quality, customer experience, and engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

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Compunetics — Director of Operations and Engineering Management | 2000–2013

- Progressed through R&D; program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls; collaborated with high-consequence partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.

Complementary operating evidence

Cardinal Building Products — Regional Director | 2021–2023: Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, and online-buying workflows.

ZeusVu — Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations | 2018–2022: Led regulated drone operations with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents; developed TensorFlow-based aerial inventory concepts and governed medical-delivery concepts.

Enviro Social Capital — Chairman of the Board | 2014–2017: Co-founded a public-private impact initiative and helped shape a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept.

IEEE — CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair | 2012–2016: Connected industry, academia, manufacturing, and emerging technology through regional programming.

Education, selected credentials, and toolkit

University of Pittsburgh — Bachelor of Science. Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Selected credentials: Google AI Essentials; IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner; Six Sigma Certification.

Toolkit: Agentic AI, LLM workflows, RAG patterns, human-in-the-loop design, Python, SQL, JavaScript, TensorFlow, Tableau, ERP/Odoo, Jira, Confluence, HubSpot, Slack, GIS and mapping workflows.

Candidate vision for Ontra

The live candidate vision demonstrates the AI Operating Precedent, cross-functional decision architecture, and a 120-day contribution plan. <https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>